
Three Sacred Suttas

Tisso Suttanta

Pali Text with English Translation

I. Karaniyametta Sutta

The Discourse on Loving-Kindness

II. Maha Mangala Sutta

The Discourse on the Supreme Blessings

III. Ratana Sutta

The Discourse on the Jewels

*From the Khuddakapatha and Sutta Nipata of the Pali Canon
Khuddaka Nikaya, Theravada Tipitaka*

I

Karaniyametta Sutta

The Discourse on Loving-Kindness

Sutta Nipata 1.8 / Khuddakapatha 9

The Karaniyametta Sutta is one of the most widely chanted suttas in the Theravada tradition. It was taught by the Buddha to a group of monks who were frightened by forest spirits while meditating in the wilderness. The sutta describes the qualities of a person who wishes to attain peace, and the practice of universal loving-kindness (metta) towards all beings.

~1~

*Karaniyam atthakusalena,
yam tam santam padam abhisamecca;
Sakko uju ca suhuju ca,
suvaco c'assa mudu anatimani.*

This is what should be done by one who is skilled in goodness, and who knows the path of peace: Let them be able, upright, and straightforward, of gentle speech and not proud.

~2~

*Santussako ca subharo ca,
appakicco ca sallahukavutti;
Santindriyo ca nipako ca,
appagabbho kulesu ananugiddho.*

Let them be contented and easily supported, unburdened with duties and frugal in their ways. Peaceful and calm, and wise and skillful, not haughty or demanding in nature.

~3~

*Na ca khuddam samacare kinci,
yena vinnu pare upavadeyyum;
Sukhino va khemino hontu,
sabbe satta bhavantu sukhitatta.*

Let them not do the slightest thing that the wise would later reprove. Wishing: In gladness and in safety, may all beings be at ease.

~4~

*Ye keci panabhut'atthi,
tasa va thavara va anavasesa;
Digha va ye mahanta va,
majjhima rassaka anukathula.*

Whatever living beings there may be; whether they are weak or strong, omitting none, the great or the mighty, medium, short or small.

~ 5 ~

*Dittha va yeve adittha,
ye ca dure vasanti avidure;
Bhuta va sambhavesi va,
sabbe satta bhavantu sukhitatta.*

The seen and the unseen, those living near and far away, those born and to-be-born: May all beings be at ease!

~ 6 ~

*Na paro param nikubbetha,
natimannetha katthaci nam kanci;
Byarosana patighasanna,
nannamannassa dukkham iccheyya.*

Let none deceive another, or despise any being in any state. Let none through anger or ill-will wish harm upon another.

~ 7 ~

*Mata yatha niyam puttam,
ayusa ekaputtam anurakkhe;
Evampi sabbabhutesu,
manasam bhavaye aparimanam.*

Even as a mother protects with her life her child, her only child, so with a boundless heart should one cherish all living beings.

~ 8 ~

*Mettam ca sabba-lokasmim,
manasam bhavaye aparimanam;
Uddham adho ca tiriya ca,
asambadham averam asapattam.*

Radiating kindness over the entire world: spreading upwards to the skies, and downwards to the depths; outwards and unbounded, freed from hatred and ill-will.

~ 9 ~

*Tittham caram nisinno va,
sayano va yavat'assa vigatamiddho;
Etam satim adhittheyya,
brahmam etam viharam idham ahu.*

Whether standing or walking, seated or lying down, free from drowsiness, one should sustain this recollection. This is said to be the sublime abiding.

*Ditthim ca anupagamma silava,
dassanena sampanno;
Kamesu vineyya gedham,
na hi jatu gabbhaseyyam punar eti ti.*

By not holding to fixed views, the pure-hearted one, having clarity of vision, being freed from all sense desires, is not born again into this world.

II

Maha Mangala Sutta

The Discourse on the Supreme Blessings

Sutta Nipata 2.4 / Khuddakapatha 5

The Maha Mangala Sutta was taught by the Buddha at Jeta's Grove when a deity asked about the supreme blessings. At that time, the question of what constitutes true blessings had been debated across the heavenly and human realms for twelve years. The Buddha's answer enumerates thirty-eight blessings covering the entire path of the good life, from avoiding fools to the realisation of Nibbana.

~ Nidana (Introduction) ~

Evam me sutam.

Ekam samayam Bhagava Savatthiyam viharati

Jetavane Anathapindikassa arame.

Atha kho annatara devata abhikkantaya rattiya

abhikkantavanno kevalakappam Jetavanam obhasetva

yena Bhagava ten'upasankami.

Upasankamitva Bhagavantam abhivadetva

ekamantam atthasi.

Ekamantam thita kho sa devata

Bhagavantam gathaya ajjhabhasi:

Thus have I heard. On one occasion the Blessed One was dwelling at the monastery of Anathapindika in Jeta's Grove, near Savatthi. Then, when the night was far spent, a certain deity whose surpassing splendour illuminated the entire Jeta's Grove, came to the presence of the Blessed One, and, drawing near, respectfully saluted him and stood to one side. Standing thus, the deity addressed the Blessed One in verse:

~ 1 ~

Bahu deva manussa ca,

mangalani acintayum;

Akankhamana sotthana,

bruhi mangalam uttamam.

Many deities and men, yearning after good, have pondered on blessings. Pray, tell me the supreme blessing.

~ 2 ~

Asevana ca balanam,

panditananca sevana;

Puja ca pujaniyaanam,

etam mangalam uttamam.

Not to associate with the foolish, but to associate with the wise; and to honour those who are worthy of honour -- this is the supreme blessing.

~3~

*Patirupa-desa-vaso ca,
pubbe ca katapunnataa;
Atta-samma-panidhi ca,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

To reside in a suitable locality, to have done meritorious actions in the past, and to set oneself in the right course -- this is the supreme blessing.

~4~

*Bahusaccanca sippanca,
vinayo ca susikkhito;
Subhasita ca ya vaca,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

Much learning, skill in handicraft, a highly trained discipline, and pleasant speech -- this is the supreme blessing.

~5~

*Mata-pitu-upatthaanam,
putta-darassa sangaho;
Anakula ca kammanta,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

Supporting one's father and mother, cherishing wife and children, and peaceful occupations -- this is the supreme blessing.

~6~

*Dananca dhammacariya ca,
natakananca sangaho;
Anavajjani kammani,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

Generosity, righteous conduct, helping one's relatives, and blameless actions -- this is the supreme blessing.

~7~

*Arati virati papa,
majjapana ca sannamo;
Appamado ca dhammesu,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

To cease and abstain from evil, forbearance with respect to intoxicants, and steadfastness in virtue -- this is the supreme blessing.

~ 8 ~

*Garavo ca nivato ca,
santutthi ca katannutaa;
Kalena dhammassavanam,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

Reverence, humility, contentment, gratitude, and hearing the Dhamma on suitable occasions -- this is the supreme blessing.

~ 9 ~

*Khanti ca sovacassata,
samananancā dassanam;
Kalena dhammasakaccha,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

Patience, obedience, sight of the Samanas (holy ones), and religious discussions on suitable occasions -- this is the supreme blessing.

~ 10 ~

*Tapo ca brahmacariyanca,
ariyasaccana dassanam;
Nibbanasacchikiriya ca,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

Self-control, holy life, perception of the Noble Truths, and the realisation of Nibbana -- this is the supreme blessing.

~ 11 ~

*Putthassa lokadhammehi,
cittam yassa na kampati;
Asokam virajam khemam,
etam mangalam uttamam.*

A mind unshaken when touched by the worldly conditions, sorrowless, stainless, and secure -- this is the supreme blessing.

~ 12 ~

*Etadisani katvana,
sabbattham aparajita;
Sabbattha sotthim gacchanti,
tam tesam mangalam uttaman ti.*

Those who thus abide, ever remain invincible, in happiness established. These are the supreme blessings.

III

Ratana Sutta

The Discourse on the Jewels

Sutta Nipata 2.1 / Khuddakapatha 6

The Ratana Sutta was taught by the Buddha when the city of Vesali was afflicted by famine, plague, and evil spirits. The Buddha instructed the Venerable Ananda to walk through the city reciting this discourse as a form of protection (paritta). The sutta extols the virtues of the Triple Gem -- the Buddha, the Dhamma, and the Sangha -- as the three supreme jewels.

~ 1 ~

*Yanidha bhutani samagatani,
bhummani va yanidha antalikkhe;
Sabbe va bhuta sumana bhavantu,
athopi sakkacca sunantu bhasitam.*

Whatever beings are assembled here, whether terrestrial or celestial, may all beings be happy, and may they listen attentively to these words.

~ 2 ~

*Tasma hi bhuta nisametha sabbe,
mettam karotha manusiya pajaya;
Diva ca ratto ca haranti ye balim,
tasma hi ne rakkhatha appamatta.*

Therefore, listen closely, all you beings. Show kindness to the human race. Day and night they bring you offerings; therefore, guard them diligently.

~ 3 ~

*Yam kinci vittam idha va huraṃ va,
saggesu va yam ratanam panitam;
Na no samam atthi Tathagatena,
idam pi Buddhhe ratanam panitam;
Etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

Whatever treasure there be either here or hereafter, whatever precious jewel there be in the heavenly worlds, there is none comparable to the Tathagata (the Perfect One). This precious jewel is the Buddha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 4 ~

*Khayam viragam amatam panitam,
yad ajjhaga Sakyamuni samahito;
Na tena dhammena samatthi kinci,
idam pi Dhamme ratanam panitam;
Etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

The cessation, the passionless, the deathless, the excellent, which Sakyamuni (the Buddha) reached through concentration -- there is nothing equal to that Dhamma. This precious jewel is the Dhamma. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 5 ~

*Yam Buddhasevho parivannayi sucim,
samadhim anantarikam namamhu;
Samadhina tena samo na vijjati,
idam pi Dhamme ratanam panitam;
Etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

The supreme Buddha extolled a path of purity, the concentration of uninterrupted progress, called 'the path giving immediate results.' No equal to that concentration can be found. This precious jewel is the Dhamma. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 6 ~

*Ye puggala attha satam pasattha,
cattari etani yugani honti;
Te dakkhineyyaa Sugatassa savaka,
etesu dinnani mahapphalani;
Idam pi Sanghe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

The eight persons, the four pairs, praised by the virtuous, they are the disciples of the Blessed One, worthy of offerings. Gifts given to them yield abundant fruit. This precious jewel is the Sangha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 7 ~

*Ye suppayutta manasa dalh'ena,
nikkamino Gotamasasanamhi;
Te pattipatta amata vigayha,
laddha mudha nibbutim bhunjamana;
Idam pi Sanghe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

Those who devoted themselves, with a firm mind, in the dispensation of Gotama, free from defilements, have attained the deathless, the highest goal, enjoying the peace of Nibbana. This precious jewel is the Sangha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 8 ~

*Yathindakhilo pathavim sito siya,
catubbhi vatehi asampakampiyo;
Tathupamam sappurisam vadami,
yo ariyasaccani avecca passati;
Idam pi Sanghe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

As a pillar planted deep in the earth cannot be shaken by the four winds, so too I declare the noble person to be, who sees the Noble Truths with thorough understanding. This precious jewel is the Sangha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 9 ~

*Ye ariyasaccani vibhavayanti,
gambhirapannena sudesitani;
Kincapi te honti bhusappamatta,
na te bhavam atthamam adiyanti;
Idam pi Sanghe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

Those who realise the Noble Truths well taught by the One of deep wisdom, however much they may be negligent, they will not take an eighth existence. This precious jewel is the Sangha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 10 ~

*Sahavassa dassanasampadaya,
tayassu dhamma jahita bhavanti;
Sakkaya-ditthi vicikicchitanca,
silabbatam va pi yad atthi kinci;
Catuhapayehi ca vippamutto,
cha cabhithanani abhabbo katum;
Idam pi Sanghe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

On attaining the vision of the Noble Path, three states are abandoned: identity view, doubt, and clinging to rules and rituals. One is freed from the four states of misery and is incapable of committing the six grave wrongs. This precious jewel is the Sangha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 11 ~

*Kincapi so kammam karoti papakam,
kayena vaca uda cetasa va;
Abhabbo so tassa paticchadaya,
abhabbata ditthipadassa vutta;
Idam pi Sanghe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

Whatever wrong one may do, whether by body, speech, or mind, one is incapable of concealing it. This inability has been declared of one who has seen the Noble Path. This precious jewel is the Sangha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 12 ~

*Vanappagumbe yatha phussitagge,
gimhanamase pathamasmim gimhe;
Tathupamam dhammavaram adesayi,
nibbanagamim paramam hitaya;
Idam pi Buddhhe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

Like woodland groves with blossoming treetops in the first month of summer, so is the sublime Dhamma leading to Nibbana which the Buddha taught for the highest good. This precious jewel is the Buddha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 13 ~

*Varo varannu varado varaharo,
anuttaro dhammavaram adesayi;
Idam pi Buddhhe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

The Excellent One, the knower of the excellent, the giver of the excellent, the bringer of the excellent, the peerless one, taught the excellent Dhamma. This precious jewel is the Buddha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 14 ~

*Khinam puranam navam natthi sambhavam,
virattacitta ayatike bhavasmin;
Te khinabija avirulhicchanda,
nibbanti dhira yathayam padipo;
Idam pi Sanghe ratanam panitam,
etena saccena suvatthi hotu.*

Their past is exhausted, their new (existence) has no arising, their minds not attached to future becoming. Their seeds destroyed, their desires no longer grow. Those wise ones go out even as this lamp. This precious jewel is the Sangha. By this truth, may there be well-being.

~ 15 ~

*Yanidha bhutani samagatani,
bhummani va yanidha antalikkhe;
Tathagatam deva-manussa-pujitam,
Buddham namassama suvatthi hotu.*

Whatever beings are assembled here, terrestrial or celestial, let us salute the Buddha, the Tathagata honoured by devas and men. May there be well-being.

~ 16 ~

*Yanidha bhutani samagatani,
bhummani va yanidha antalikkhe;
Tathagatam deva-manussa-pujitam,
Dhammam namassama suvatthi hotu.*

Whatever beings are assembled here, terrestrial or celestial, let us salute the Dhamma, the Tathagata honoured by devas and men. May there be well-being.

*Yanidha bhutani samagatani,
bhummani va yanidha antalikkhe;
Tathagatam deva-manussa-pujitam,
Sangham namassama suvatthi hotu.*

Whatever beings are assembled here, terrestrial or celestial, let us salute the Sangha, the Tathagata honoured by devas and men. May there be well-being.

Sadhu! Sadhu! Sadhu!

May the merit of reciting these suttas bring peace and happiness to all beings.

These texts are from the Khuddakapatha and Sutta Nipata of the Pali Canon (Theravada Tipitaka). Pali spellings follow standard romanised convention without diacritical marks for accessibility. English translations draw from the well-known renderings in the Theravada tradition.